🗳️ Women's Suffrage: Reading

US History · Unit 8 · Level 2 (modified) · our own reading

Name: _____



Inez Milholland leads the 1913 suffrage parade

Winning the Vote

For most of U.S. history, women could not vote. Many people believed women belonged at home, not in politics.

In 1848, Elizabeth Cady Stanton and Lucretia Mott led a meeting at **Seneca Falls**, New York. They wrote that “all men and women are created equal.”

Susan B. Anthony traveled the country giving speeches. In 1872 she voted and was **arrested** and fined. She refused to pay.

Some western states, like Wyoming, let women vote early. Others did not. Carrie Chapman Catt led NAWSA in a plan to win state by state and in Congress.

Alice Paul used bolder ways: a big **parade** in 1913 and the Silent Sentinels at the White House. Some women were jailed and went on hunger strike.

During World War I, women worked in factories and as nurses. It was hard to say women could not vote while they helped win the war.

In 1920 the **19th Amendment** was ratified. Millions of women voted for the first time that November.

Check your reading

1. What happened at Seneca Falls in 1848?

A. Women got the vote

B. A war started

C. Women met and said they should have equal rights

2. How did WWI help women win the vote?

A. Women's war work showed they deserved a voice

B. Women left the U.S.

C. The war ended voting

3. Which amendment gave women the vote?

A. the 1st

B. the 13th

C. the 19th

4. Why do you think it took 72 years (1848 to 1920)?